

Impact Medium · Difficulty Easy-Medium · Misuse risk It fails when the "small" ask is a disguise for a big one — bait-and-switch

THE MOVE

Shrink the scope: ask for one part, not the whole. -> Name the exact action: say precisely what you want done. -> Make the boundary honest: state what you are not asking for. -> Accept yes or no cleanly: leave the choice genuinely open. -> ?

START HERE

Name one small, concrete part of what you need and ask for only that: "Could you do just X?"

SAY THIS

Quick asks	<i>"Could you do just this one part?"</i>
Warm and social	<i>"No rush, but could you do just the one thing when you get a sec?"</i>
Work and meetings	<i>"Could we decide only the next step in this meeting?"</i>
Naming the exact act...	<i>"Could you look at just the first paragraph?"</i>
Softening and steppi...	<i>"No pressure at all — only if you have the time."</i>
Guarded or high-status	<i>"Would it be useful if I checked the premise before I respond?"</i>

AVOID

- The real ask is large and deserves to be named honestly
- The person needs full context to give genuine consent
- A clean request or low-friction ask would be more transparent

REMEMBER

Shrink the ask, not the honesty.